

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1996-10-28

To the National and regional Spiritual Assemblies

dear bahá'í friends,

outstanding achievement recently accomplished by the National Spiritual Assembly of the bahá'ís of france: the acquisition for the cause of god

of the apartment at 4, Avenue de camoëns in paris in which 'Abdu'l-bahá stayed during his historic visit to the city.

This marks the first step in the acquisition of sites sanctified by the residence of the master in the cities of europe during the three visits he made

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1996–2000 • The Four Year Plan

555to that continent, between 1911 and 1913, for the purpose of spreading the message of bahá'u'lláh, sites which are second only in holiness to those places in istanbul and edirne where the manifestation of god himself blessed the soil of the european continent.

with loving bahá'í greetings,

for Department of the Secretariat

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Message to the Arctic Teaching Conference and the

Inauguration of a Bahá'í Center in the Arctic Region

November 1996

To the followers of bahá'u'lláh gathered at the Arctic Teaching conference

and the inauguration of the lapland bahá'í center in inari

beloved friends,

The inauguration of a bahá'í center in inari, in the heart of the home-

land of the Sami peoples is an event of great significance for the advancement of the cause of bahá'u'lláh in the Arctic regions. This center is, at one

and the same time, the paḡíratu'l-quds of the bahá'ís of inari and a center for the study and activities of the faith throughout a region which spreads across four countries from the Atlantic ocean in the west to the white Sea in the east, involving the active collaboration of four National Spiritual Assemblies.

may this Arctic Teaching conference, held on so auspicious an occasion, give renewed vision and inspiration to all who take part. may your deliberations bring forth well-conceived plans and projects and cement the active collaboration of all bahá'í institutions in the region. may each individual participant carry from it a bright light to illumine the hearts and minds of the inhabitants of the northlands and win victories that will excite the admiration and emulation of their fellow believers throughout the european continent and in all the Arctic lands.

we shall offer fervent prayers at the Sacred Threshold for divine bounties and confirmations to guide your steps and reinforce your every endeavor in the path of his cause.

with loving bahá'í greetings,

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message from The Universal House of Justice

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Four Bahá'í Prisoners in Iran Sentenced to Death

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]